

One answer is: Yes.

Physical properties can
cause phenomenal
properties, **and**

phenomenal properties can
cause physical properties.

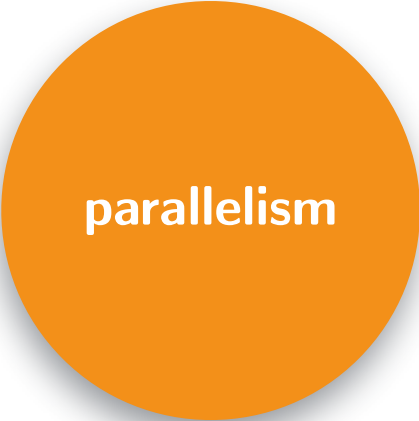
A second answer is: Yes.

Physical properties can
cause phenomenal
properties; **but** phenomenal
properties cannot cause
physical properties.

A third answer is: No.
Physical and phenomenal
properties cannot causally
interact.

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interactionism

A large, solid orange circle is centered on a white background. The word "parallelism" is written in white, bold, lowercase letters across the middle of the circle.

parallelism



**epi-
phenomenalism**

Each of these views has its own strengths and weaknesses.

ANN'S BLOOD SUGAR
FALLS BELOW 80
MG/DL

ANN FEELS HUNGER,
AND DECIDES TO
WALK TO THE
FRIDGE.

ANN WALKS TO THE
FRIDGE AND OPENS
THE DOOR

ANN HAS A VISUAL
SENSATION OF AN
APPLE AND DECIDES TO
EAT IT.

ANN REACHES OUT FOR THE
APPLE AND BRINGS IT TO
HER MOUTH AND TAKES A
BITE.

ANN TASTES THE APPLE
AND FEELS LESS
HUNGRY .





Let's start with the parallelist. This looks like the craziest of the
three views -- why would anyone hold it?





One reason for taking parallelism seriously is that causal connections between the physical and mental realms can look very puzzling.

A second argument is also simple. Once we think that there are no causal connections between the physical and mental worlds at all, why should we keep believing in a physical world at all?

This thought puts some pressure on the parallelist to become an
idealist, who denies that there is any physical world at all.



Here is what our causal chain looks like, according to the idealist.

One answer is: Yes.

causal/physical properties.

phenomenal properties can

Physical properties can

causaphenomenal

properties, and

causal phenomena

properties cannot cause

A second answer is: Yes.

Physical properties can

properties; but phenomena

physical properties.

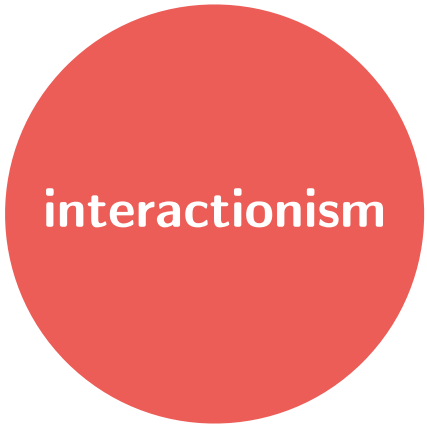
properties cannot causally

Physical and phenomenal

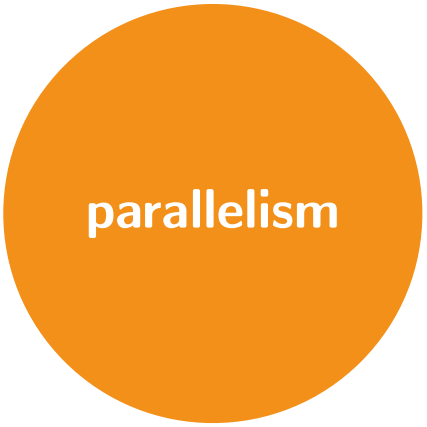


interact.

Third answer: No.



interactionism

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parallelism

epi-

phenomenalism



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AND DECIDES TO
WALK TO THE
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ANN HAS A VISUAL
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